



Bharat Chaudhary

10 MISTAKES

TO AVOID IN A JOB APPLICATION FOR GERMANY



UNPROFESSIONAL PHOTO



Nowadays, CV nearly **always** has a **photo**. But not just any photo. It would help if you had a **professional headshot** and **not** a picture of you in a **floral shirt from a vacation**. A professional photo also doesn't mean a photo with a professional camera with you in your beach trousers, it has to be a **studio picture** and preferably in professional clothing. If you want some good ideas, you can **browse over LinkedIn** and look at some examples from your **favourite CEOs**. As a rule of thumb, do the following:

- Pick a plain background
- The colour of your clothing shouldn't blend in with the background; otherwise it would be as if you are the wall.
- Smile, because it is not a passport photo
- Remember it is not a passport photo, so maybe tilt your shoulders a little towards the other side

Actually, you know what would be a **great idea**?

A great idea would be to **search for employees of a particular company** that you want to apply to and then **get a similar photo**. That will give the company you are applying to, a **good feeling** about you.



MISSING/INCORRECT INFO



Recruiting and **hiring managers** hate nothing more than **incorrect** or **missing information**. Your job is to make their job of hiring you easier and not the other way around. Make sure the **hyperlinks of your LinkedIn profile** are working well and your email address and normal address are complete. Watch out for the following information:

- The subject line in Cover Letter
- Complete address of the Company you are applying to
- The correct title of the person you are referring to in your Cover Letter
- Reference of where you found the job position
- Most importantly avoid typing errors.

Double-check or **triple check** everything. Make someone else read your CV and Cover Letter. Sometimes even wrong punctuation marks in the wrong places can ruin it for you. And if you think about it, it makes sense. If in the **job description** it is written that they are **looking for a candidate** who has **attention to detail** then you might wanna avoid making such **small mistakes** in your own CV and Cover Letter.



UNEVEN/INCOSISTENT LAYOUT



Remember how we talked about '**attention to detail**'? Yeah, There's another **big blunder** most applicants make that they don't even see (but of course recruiters see **EVERYTHING**). And I know this because I've received nearly a **100 CV's and Cover Letters** for my **Company** and also corrected a few hundred if not thousand CV's myself. And there is this **one mistake** that is so common in all of them, which is the **inconsistent layout**. By that I mean, different font sizes and styles and also uneven formatting throughout the CV or Cover Letter.

Quick tips:

- Use **one format style** and **size** for the text body and differentiate the main heading by either making them slightly more prominent, bold or with a different font.
- Make the text '**Justified**' in the Cover Letter
- Make sure the font style you use is something **simple** like **Arial or Times New Roman**.
- Make sure the **alignment** of all the **paragraphs** is the same.
- Such things are hard to miss but applicants still make these mistakes none the less.



RELYING ON JOB PORTALS



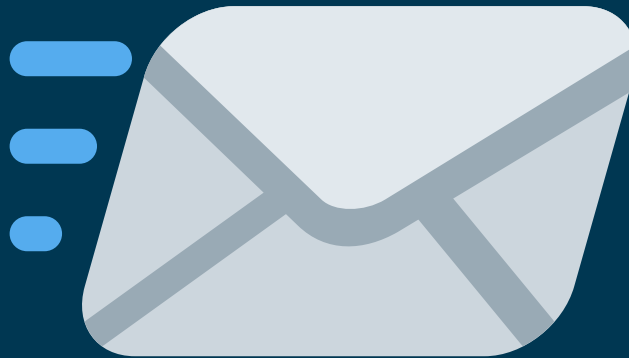
Everyone has a **go-to place** or simply a **go-to anything**. When it comes to applying for jobs, **job portals** are something people flock to like **bees to honey**. Even though they are useful '**to some extent**' relying on them completely is **not so wise**. Let me tell you why I say that:

- Jobs get **posted** on job portals after they get **posted everywhere else**
- Everyone is **looking for jobs on job portals** so that means **huge competition**
- Sometimes there are **no more job openings** but it is **still being shown** at the job portal. Outdated Information
- Sometimes they are **even harder** to navigate because the information is inaccurate

And that is why you have to **directly apply** to the **company**. And this is exactly what I will teach you in my **Job Course**, that is **how to apply to a company even if there is no open position?**



IMPERSONAL & IMPRRCISE EMAILS



I already told you that **job portals** are not the **right way** to go about **job applications**. What you should be doing is **sending emails to companies directly**.

But what should you say?

How should you say it?

How should you formulate your subject line?

Should you directly get to the point?

Or should you try to do small talk first?

In my **course**, I will be **teaching** all of these things. I know about such things because **I myself applied to companies directly** by writing them an email.

That's how I got my internship.

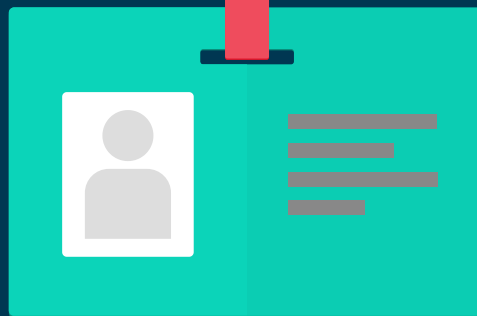
That's how I got my working student job.

What you say to the **hiring manager** or even the **manager** of the **company** and how you say it will decide if you get invited for an interview.

I know it may seem a **bit strange** to you when I tell you that you should look elsewhere for jobs and not on **job portal** but there are **many people** who get jobs by **simply talking** to the **right people with the right words at the right time**.



IMPERSONAL SALUTATION



Literally, **everyone** writes '**Sehr geehrte Damen und Herren**' but very few people actually go through the trouble of finding out the **name of the person** viewing the application. Sometimes it's not even that hard to find and is **literally given on the page in some corner**. Do you want to be remembered by the recruiter? Then try to find out their name and address the **Cover Letter** directly to them by writing their name. I will share with you some of the most common ways to find out such details:

- Usually, the **contact person** is mentioned somewhere around the **job advertisement itself**
- You can also **call the company** and ask
- Alternatively, you can **send an email** to inquire about the **hiring person name**

By doing things like **calling the company to find out the name of the hiring person** and **addressing them personally** by their name in the **Cover Letter or email** builds a good impression about you. More importantly, when you have a **name** you can **search the person** named on the internet to find out more about the person and somehow incorporate that knowledge in your email or your cover letter. **Remember, the ultimate goal is to be stand out and make an impression.**



CLICHE INTRODUCTORY SENTENCES



How **boring** is it to read the **same sentence** over and over again in every **Cover Letter, CV and email**? The most boring sentence recruiters read is '**I hereby apply for the position of...**'. Recruiters have moved on from this **age-old tradition** and so should you. We live in a world where **storytelling sells**. Therefore if you want to **capture** the **reader's attention**, come up with something creative and interesting about yourself. Here are some tips:

- If you **called** the **company previously** (which you should) then you can start the sentence with something as simple as "**I previously had an interesting conversation with Mr Schneider** (literally the most German last name in the world) **who works in 'Name of the Company' as 'Position' and he referred me for the advertised job position**".
- Some **personal relation** to the company or your motivation for applying. Something like '**The Company's work in XYZ sector captures my attention as the work being done by the company is perfectly in line with my vision and motivation**'.
- You can even start the sentence with something interesting about you.

The key is to be **original** and **creative** and **interesting**. Remember that it is all about first impressions. Handle that correctly and you will manage what most people don't.



RETELLING YOUR RESUME



Your **Cover Letter** is not an **extension of your CV**. Period. In your CV you write your **educational qualification** but you should not mention it again in your Cover Letter. What you should mention is **specific details** from your **educational qualification** that **qualify** you for the job. Think of a **CV as a factual sheet**. The facts should be **expanded upon** in the **Cover Letter** in a detailed and more personalized manner. For tips and tricks read the points mentioned below:

- Pick up **keywords** from the **job description** and explain your previous job or educational qualification with those keywords.
- Pick **facts** from your **CV** that are **most relevant** for the **job** you are applying to. You don't have to **mention every detail** and more importantly, **no recruiter** has the time to **read long stories** but they definitely want to know **something interesting about you**. Your job is to tell them something interesting about yourself in an **elevator pitch format**.
- Do you know what an **elevator pitch** is? Well imagine you meet the **CEO of a company** in an **elevator** and he asks you **who you are and what you do**. Now is your **time to shine**. You have to tell him something about yourself in a very short time period that he will remember throughout the day.

The best way to write a short draft is to write it over and over again and remove the things that are not important or can be re-written.



WRONG USE OF KEYWORDS



You must have heard that for your **CV to make it past the first screening**, you should **include keywords** from the **job description** in your **CV** and **Cover Letter**. What most people do is that if in the job description, it is written that the company is looking for a **self-motivated individual** with **attention to detail** and **good organization skills**, most candidates write under their soft skills that they are **motivated, organized and have attention to detail**. All the other applicants are doing the same. But a smart applicant knows that this is not the correct way. A smart applicant knows that:

- He has to **explain exactly** how he has all these qualities by explaining things from his previous job or his studies.
- He has to **mention projects** that he undertook and how all the **selected keywords were a part of his task**. Anyone can write that they have attention to detail. What recruiters are looking for is information around an applicants **attention to detail**.



TOO MANY 'UNIMPORTANT' DETAILS



So you were in the **debate club** during your **university years** and also won the **fancy dress competition** in the **7th grade**. Do you think you should mention that in your CV? **Absolutely not!** More is not always better. There are usually **two reasons** behind writing everything that you've done in your life in your CV. The **first** is because you want to **tell the recruiter** how **brilliant** you are by listening down every tiny activity you've done till date and the **second** reason is if you're trying to **compensate for not having enough professional or educational qualification** by mentioning extracurricular activities. Recruiters see right through the **bullshit**. Here are some tips and guidelines that you should follow:

- **Stick** to things that are **directly related** to the job.
- **Skip** on the **unimportant** stuff.
- If you mention everything you've done, the chances are that things that are **actually important** for you to get that job might get **overlooked**.
- Mentioning some **volunteer work** is always a good idea as it **shows initiative and willingness to take on extra work**.

Remember; less is sometimes more.



COMPLETE COURSE FOR FINDING JOBS IN GERMANY



If you want to make **successful job applications**, **not waste time** in applying to **50 companies** every week and not even **making past the first CV screening**, join **the Complete Course for Finding Jobs in Germany** and learn the **best practices** of applying for jobs in Germany.

You get lifetime access to the course and document review once you have gone through the course at a super affordable price.

Click on the button below to learn more about the course:

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